emotions, but holding Isha in my arms was a wondrous feeling. We had already decided on the names, Isha for a girl and . . . I've forgotten really what it was for a boy. Angad perhaps, after Guru Angadji. The next two weeks were a different kind of learning process. Nobody teaches you to be a parent; you learn on the job. Learning how to change a diaper, fastening it with a curved safety pin, was as difficult as *khola-jodna*, stripping and re-assembling a rifle. Disposable diapers were not in vogue yet, so washing soiled diapers, and drying and folding them was a daily chore. A stack of folded diapers was a lovely, oddly satisfying sight. The days passed by much too soon and it was time to rejoin the Centre. It was tough to leave them both, with her parents, the only solace being that Veena and Isha would be joining me as soon as I was allotted married accommodation.

Fatehgarh was a tough peace station, the main issue being very poor power supply. There was only one HT line supplying the garrison, colloquially called the *gyarah hazaar line*, the 11,000 Kw line, which was the main feeder to the station. The transformer it fed into would 'blow up' at regular intervals. Whenever that happened, a new transformer had to be brought in from somewhere, and this whole process took three to four days. Four days and nights without electricity were taxing, to say the least, and enough to drive everyone crazy. The office complex had a diesel generator (DG) as did the Officers' and JCOs' Mess, but that was it. When we broached the subject of getting a generator for the officers' accommodation, Brig Tewari was very firm. First, all the men's living lines (barracks) should have generators, he said, only then will we get generators for ourselves. We groaned inwardly, thinking that this would never happen, but he was true to his word, making use of all avenues, public and Regimental funds, and by the time I was to leave the Centre two years later, each of the officers' complexes had a

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